DIPLOMATIC WORKING DOCUMENT — MODULAR ANNEX

Annex O

IAEA Access and Site Integrity Protocol

May be Incorporated by Reference into Any Existing or Future Framework

Version 2.5 — June 2026

Closes Gap 1: IAEA Access to Damaged Sites

Authorized Negotiators Only

Confidential — Not for Public Distribution

Standalone Modular Protocol

THE IMMUTABLE PRESENT-TENSE MATRIX (V2.5) Applied

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Preamble

Purpose

To ensure immediate, safe, and unimpeded access for International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) inspectors to all declared Iranian nuclear facilities, including areas damaged during military operations, for the purpose of Highly Enriched Uranium (HEU) inventory, verification, and custody transfer operations under Article 1 of the parent framework.

Background

The IAEA has not had full access to certain Iranian nuclear facilities for an extended period. Structural damage from military strikes may have affected the integrity of HEU storage cylinders and the accessibility of declared sites. This Annex establishes the protocols necessary to resolve both access and integrity issues without delay to the Phase I implementation timeline established in the parent framework.

Recent reporting confirms that IAEA inspector teams have been denied entry to or had their movements restricted at multiple declared facilities, including areas within the Esfahan Nuclear Technology Center and portions of the Natanz complex. The physical condition of cylinder storage areas remains unverified. This information gap constitutes a direct impediment to Article 1 HEU custody exchange operations and creates unquantified risk in the verification chain.

Relationship to Parent Framework

This Annex supplements and does not replace the verification architecture established in the parent framework. All obligations under Article 1 (HEU Custody Exchange Protocol), Article 3 (Underground Site Conversion & Mothball Protocol), and Article 13 (Human-in-the-Loop Governance) remain in full force. Where this Annex provides specific protocols for damaged or restricted-access sites, the provisions of this Annex govern.

Modularity Clause

This Annex is self-contained and may be incorporated into any existing or future agreement between the Parties by a single sentence of adoption. It does not amend or supersede conflicting provisions of any parent framework unless the Parties explicitly so agree. In the event of inconsistency between this Annex and any parent framework provision, this Annex governs with respect to IAEA access, damage assessment, and recovery operations for damaged nuclear material.

Article 1: Immediate IAEA Access

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

1.1 Declared Facilities Covered. Iran and the IAEA shall cooperate to enable full, continuous access to all declared nuclear facilities, including but not limited to all areas identified in the IAEA Safeguards Agreement and Additional Protocol designations, regardless of physical condition or operational status. Iran shall make all reasonable efforts to facilitate safe and timely IAEA access; the IAEA shall conduct all activities in a manner that respects Iranian sovereignty and facility safety protocols.

Access extends to the following facilities and all associated storage, processing, and support areas within their declared perimeters:

Table O-1: Declared Nuclear Facilities Subject to Annex O Access Protocols

Facility	IAEA Code	Areas Included	Special Access Notes
Natanz Fuel Enrichment Plant	IR-NAT-01	Above-ground halls, underground Fuel Enrichment Plant (FEP), Pilot Fuel Enrichment Plant (PFEP), all associated cylinder storage areas	Including areas reported damaged in above-ground sections; underground access per existing safeguards designations
Fordow Fuel Enrichment Plant	IR-FOR-01	All levels and tunnels, including access shafts, main halls, support galleries, and declared storage areas	Deep tunnel access subject to radiation safety protocols but not to political preconditions
Esfahan Nuclear Technology Center	IR-ESF-01	All declared buildings including uranium conversion facilities (UCF), fuel fabrication plant (FFP), and all cylinder storage areas including those reported damaged	Priority facility for initial access given reported damage to cylinder storage areas
Arak Heavy Water Production Plant	IR-ARA-01	Reactor vessel area, heavy water storage, all declared processing buildings	Access to verify no undeclared HEU storage at heavy water facility
Bushehr Nuclear Power Plant	IR-BUS-01	Spent fuel storage pool, fresh fuel reception area, reactor building per safeguards protocol	Access for spent fuel verification only; not for operational inspection of power generation systems
Karaj Complex (TESA)	IR-KAR-01	All declared buildings including centrifuge component manufacturing areas	Subject to Article 3 mothball protocol coordination
Declared R&D Locations	Various	Any location where HEU cylinders are stored, have been stored, or are believed to have been stored based on IAEA intelligence or Member State information	Including locations where the IAEA has raised questions under the Additional Protocol

1.2 Access Rights Granted

The following access rights are jointly established to enable IAEA verification while respecting Iranian sovereignty and facility safety requirements:

1. Physical inspection of all storage areas, including damaged, collapsed, or structurally compromised sections, subject to completion of the joint safety walkthrough required under Article 1.3. No area within a declared facility perimeter may be designated permanently off-limits on grounds of physical condition alone.
2. Visual and spectroscopic examination of all HEU cylinders, including non-destructive assay (NDA) measurements, gamma spectroscopy, and neutron counting as appropriate to the cylinder condition and accessibility. Iranian technicians may participate as active partners in all measurements.
3. Environmental sampling in all accessible areas, including swipe samples from storage containers, building surfaces, ventilation systems, and soil or debris in damaged areas. Both Parties shall jointly witness and seal all samples.
4. Installation of continuous monitoring equipment, including cameras, radiation sensors, tamper-evident seals, and data transmission equipment at locations selected by mutual agreement of the IAEA inspection team and Iranian facility authorities. If mutual agreement on equipment placement cannot be reached within seventy-two (72) hours of the IAEA's initial request, either Party may refer the dispute to the JIG for a binding technical determination within forty-eight (48) hours. The JIG's determination shall be based solely on verification effectiveness and personnel safety, not on operational convenience or administrative burden. Iran shall provide access to any location designated by the JIG under this provision within twenty-four (24) hours of the determination.
5. Freedom of movement for IAEA inspectors within declared facility boundaries, subject to radiation safety requirements and structural stability assessments where physical hazards exist. Iranian escort personnel shall facilitate, not restrict, inspector movement.
6. Photographic and video documentation of all inspected areas for IAEA records and remote analysis by headquarters technical staff. Iran shall receive copies of all documentation within 72 hours.
7. Access to facility records related to cylinder storage, movement, inventory, and damage assessments. Iran shall provide all relevant records within 48 hours of IAEA request.

1.3 Timeline for Access Activation

Table O-2: Annex O Access Activation Timeline (with Safety Coordination Buffer)

Time from EIF	Action Required	Verification Method
T+0 hours	Annex O enters into force simultaneously with parent framework or by separate diplomatic exchange	Joint Secretariat timestamp; simultaneous notification to all guarantor states
T+12 hours	Iran provides initial safety briefing and hazard map to IAEA advance team (remotely or upon arrival); notifies all facility directors of pending IAEA access under Annex O	Written facility director confirmation received by IAEA Vienna; safety briefing documentation logged
T+24 hours	IAEA advance team arrives at Tehran Imam Khomeini International Airport or designated point of entry; receives comprehensive safety and hazard briefing from Iranian facility safety officers	Joint Secretariat travel log; visa facilitation confirmed; safety briefing acknowledged by IAEA Team Leader
T+48 hours	Joint safety walkthrough of first priority facility (Esfahan, unless otherwise agreed by both Parties); IAEA inspectors and Iranian facility officers jointly assess hazards, debris, and access routes before full inspection commences	Joint safety walkthrough report signed by IAEA Team Leader and Iranian Facility Director; JIG notified of any safety-related delays
T+72 hours	Full IAEA inspection access begins at Tier 1 priority facilities (Esfahan, Natanz above-ground), following completion of joint safety walkthrough	Daily IAEA inspection report filed with Joint Secretariat
T+96 hours	Full access to all declared facilities operational; all prior access restrictions lifted; joint safety walkthroughs completed at all Tier 2 facilities	JIG certification of compliance with Article 1 access obligations

Safety coordination buffer: The 96-hour timeline includes a mandatory joint safety coordination period (T+24h to T+48h) during which Iranian facility safety officers and IAEA inspectors jointly assess hazards before full inspection access commences. This buffer is not a delay mechanism; it is a joint safety protocol to protect IAEA personnel at damaged nuclear sites. No facility may be declared inaccessible on grounds of "ongoing safety assessment" beyond T+48h unless the JIG confirms a credible, site-specific safety emergency.

EIF means Entry into Force of this Annex. If this Annex is incorporated into a parent framework, EIF coincides with the parent framework's EIF unless the Parties specify otherwise.

1.4 IAEA Personnel Protections

Iran shall ensure the safety and security of all IAEA personnel exercising access rights under this Annex. Specifically:

IAEA inspectors shall be provided with Iranian escort personnel trained in radiation safety and facility-specific hazards.

In areas of structural damage, Iranian authorities shall provide advance warning of known hazards (unstable structures, radiation hotspots, chemical contamination) before IAEA personnel enter.

> **[V2.5 MATRIX AMENDMENT — ARTICLE 1.4]:** The framework architecture excludes IAEA inspector entry into areas that an independent, JIG-appointed neutral engineering team certifies as unacceptably hazardous by unanimous vote. The team comprises one Iranian nominee, one US nominee, and one PCA-appointed chair. IAEA personnel issue preliminary safety determinations only. A unanimous override by the neutral engineering team within 72 hours automatically preserves IAEA inspector access.

Such areas shall be addressed under Article 3 (Remote Recovery Protocol).

Iran shall facilitate secure communication between IAEA inspectors in the field and IAEA headquarters in Vienna, including encrypted data transmission capability.

Any interference with, intimidation of, or threat to IAEA personnel constitutes a Tier 2 material breach under the parent framework Article 13.

Article 2: Joint Damage Assessment

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

Iran and the IAEA shall conduct a joint damage assessment of all HEU cylinder storage areas within fourteen (14) days of the entry into force of this Annex. This assessment covers every declared storage location and produces a comprehensive inventory of cylinder condition, accessibility, and recommended disposition.

2.1 Assessment Scope

The joint damage assessment systematically evaluates:

1. **Cylinder location and condition.** Every HEU cylinder shall be identified by its unique identifier, located by GPS coordinates within the facility, and classified by visual and instrumental assessment into one of the following categories:
   - **Intact (Category I):** Cylinder shows no visible damage; containment integrity confirmed by pressure testing or equivalent non-destructive examination; ready for normal custody transfer and handling procedures.
   - **Damaged but Accessible (Category II):** Cylinder shows visible damage (dents, corrosion, valve compromise, external contamination) but is physically accessible to inspectors. Category II subdivides into:
     - **II-A (Minor Damage):** Cylinder is accessible and can be safely moved with standard handling procedures. Timeline: standard 14-day custody consolidation.
     - **II-B (Requires Debris Removal or Repair):** Cylinder is visible and inspectable but cannot be safely moved without prior debris clearance, structural stabilization, or cylinder repair. Timeline: up to 30 days, subject to an IAEA-approved recovery plan jointly developed with Iranian facility engineers.
   - **Inaccessible (Category III):** Cylinder is known or believed to exist in a location rendered inaccessible by structural collapse, debris, radiation levels, or other physical hazards; exact condition unknown; requires remote sensing or recovery operations under Article 3.
   - **Missing or Unaccounted (Category IV):** Cylinder was declared present in Iranian inventory records but cannot be located during the assessment. Category IV findings trigger a joint investigation. Iran shall provide all relevant records and facilitate searches. If after fourteen (14)

days no credible explanation exists, the matter escalates to the JIG. Diversion shall not be presumed without evidence.

Category IV Non-Cooperation: If Iran fails to provide requested records or facilitate searches within the 14-day joint investigation period, the 14-day timeline shall be paused for the duration of any documented non-cooperation.

The IAEA may escalate the matter to the JIG immediately upon a finding of non-cooperation, without waiting for the 14-day period to expire.

For purposes of this provision, "non-cooperation" includes: failure to respond to a documented records request within 48 hours; denial of access to relevant Iranian personnel for interview; or any action that materially impedes the investigation. The JIG shall determine by majority vote whether non-cooperation has occurred.

2. **Structural integrity of storage buildings, tunnels, and containment areas.** Assessment of load-bearing capacity, radiation shielding effectiveness, ventilation system functionality, fire suppression system status, and physical security perimeter condition.
3. **Accessibility for inspection, monitoring, and potential extraction.** Evaluation of whether each storage area can support standard IAEA inspection procedures, continuous monitoring equipment installation, and physical cylinder movement for custody transfer or downblending operations.
4. **Radiation levels and environmental hazards.** Measurement of gamma dose rates, surface contamination levels, airborne radioactivity, and presence of chemical hazards (UF_6 exposure risk, heavy water leakage) in all accessible areas.

2.2 Assessment Methodology

The joint damage assessment shall be conducted according to the following procedures:

Table O-3: Joint Damage Assessment Methodology

Phase	Timeline	Activities
Phase A: Document Review	Days 1–3	IAEA reviews all available Iranian facility records, pre-strike IAEA inspection reports, satellite imagery, and any damage assessments prepared by Iranian authorities. IAEA may request additional documents within 24 hours; Iran shall provide within 48 hours of request.
Phase B: Remote Sensing Survey	Days 2–5	IAEA deploys drones, ground-based radiation detectors, and seismic sensors to characterize damage in areas where human access requires safety preparation. Results inform prioritization of physical inspection sequence.
Phase C: Physical Inspection	Days 4–12	IAEA inspectors, with Iranian technicians as active partners, conduct joint physical examination of all accessible storage areas. Both Parties shall ensure no unnecessary delay. The IAEA has the lead technical role in determining inspection scope and method; Iranian personnel contribute facility-specific expertise and may raise safety concerns at any time.
Phase D: Instrumental Analysis	Days 8–13	Non-destructive assay (NDA) measurements on all identified cylinders. Gamma spectroscopy confirms isotopic composition. Neutron counting verifies mass estimates. Results logged in IAEA inspector report.
Phase E: Report Preparation	Days 12–14	Joint drafting of Site Integrity Report (see Section 2.3). IAEA prepares technical annexes; Iran may append observations. Both parties review and finalize by Day 14 deadline.

Lead technical role: The IAEA shall have the lead technical role in all assessments, with Iranian experts as active partners. Iranian technicians shall accompany IAEA teams, provide facility-specific expertise, and operate Iranian equipment under joint technical direction. Both Parties shall ensure that access proceeds without unnecessary delay. Either Party may raise safety concerns at any time; safety disputes shall be resolved through the procedures set out in Article 3.1.

Remote sensing supplement: Remote sensing technologies (drones with radiation detectors and cameras, satellite imagery analysis, seismic sensors) shall be used as a supplement to, and never as a substitute for, physical inspection. No cylinder shall be classified as Category I (Intact) based solely on remote sensing data.

2.3 Site Integrity Report

Within fourteen (14) days of EIF, the Parties shall deliver a joint Site Integrity Report to both Parties and the Joint Implementation Group (JIG). The Report contains the following elements:

1. **Cylinder Inventory by Location and Condition:** A complete table listing every HEU cylinder by unique identifier, declared location, GPS coordinates, condition category (I–IV), and NDA-verified isotopic enrichment.
2. **Priority Ranking:** A prioritized list of cylinders requiring verification, continuous monitoring, or recovery operations, ranked by proliferation risk (enrichment level, accessibility to potential diverters, physical security of storage location).
3. **Recommended Disposition Pathway:** For each cylinder or cylinder group, a recommended disposition based on physical feasibility:
    - Category I cylinders: Standard custody transfer and downblending per parent framework Article 1.5
    - Category II-A cylinders (minor damage): Standard custody transfer and downblending per parent framework Article 1.5, with enhanced handling protocols
    - Category II-B cylinders (requires debris removal/repair): Recovery under Article 3 within 30 days; custody transfer upon completion of IAEA-approved recovery plan
    - Category III cylinders: Article 3 remote recovery or Article 3.3 in-situ containment with enhanced monitoring
    - Category IV cylinders: Joint investigation per Article 2.1; JIG escalation after 14 days if no credible explanation found
4. **Storage Area Recovery Requirements:** Engineering assessment of infrastructure repairs needed to restore each storage area to IAEA-inspectable condition.
5. **Safety Recommendations:** Radiation and structural safety measures required before each area can support routine IAEA inspection activity.

The Site Integrity Report shall be classified as Confidential and distributed only to: the IAEA Director General and designated technical staff; the Iranian Atomic Energy Organization (AEOI) leadership; the Joint Implementation Group; and the permanent members of the UN Security Council upon formal request.

Article 3: Damaged or Inaccessible Cylinders — Joint Recovery Protocol

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

3.1 Recovery Principles. If any HEU cylinders are determined to be damaged or inaccessible (Categories II or III under Article 2), both Parties commit to a joint recovery operation under IAEA supervision. Recovery shall be conducted using remote robotics where human access is unsafe. Recovery methods shall be determined jointly. In case of disagreement, the IAEA's technical safety assessment shall prevail where human life or proliferation risk is imminent. For purposes of this Article, "imminent" proliferation risk shall have the meaning defined in Article 6.1-B. For all other matters where disagreement persists, either Party may refer the dispute to the PCA under Article 6, with an expedited ruling within five (5) days.

3.1 Recovery Principles

All recovery operations under this Article adhere to the following principles:

Table O-4: Joint Recovery Protocol Principles

Principle	Operational Requirements
Safety Paramount	No recovery operation shall proceed if it poses unacceptable radiation or structural risks to personnel. "Unacceptable risk" shall be determined jointly by the IAEA Radiation Safety Officer and Iranian nuclear safety authorities. Where there is imminent risk to human life or credible proliferation concern, the IAEA technical safety assessment prevails. For all other safety disagreements, either Party may refer the matter to expedited PCA arbitration under Article 6 within five (5) days.
Remote-First	Recovery shall be conducted using remote-controlled robotics, teleoperated manipulators, or autonomous systems wherever human access is deemed unsafe. Human entry into compromised areas requires explicit written authorization from both the IAEA Team Leader and Iranian Facility Director.
Joint Determination	Recovery methods, sequencing, and safety protocols shall be determined jointly by the IAEA and Iranian facility engineers. The IAEA has the lead technical role; Iranian personnel operate equipment as active partners under joint technical direction. Either Party may refer disagreements to expedited PCA arbitration under Article 6 within five (5) days. Neither Party may unilaterally delay an agreed recovery plan absent a credible, documented safety concern.
Transparency	All recovery operations shall be documented by continuous video recording transmitted in real time to IAEA headquarters in Vienna. No recovery operation shall be conducted off-camera or with recording interrupted.
Material Accountancy	Every recovered cylinder shall be weighed, measured by NDA, and logged in the IAEA inventory system before removal from the recovery site. Material unaccounted for (MUF) during recovery shall be calculated and reported to the JIG within 24 hours.

3.2 Recovery Timeline

Table O-5: Recovery Operation Timeline

Milestone	Deadline	Requirement
Recovery Plan Agreement	Day 21 (7 days post-Report)	Both Parties shall agree on a written Recovery Plan specifying: recovery sequencing; robotics and equipment to be deployed; personnel roles and responsibilities; radiation safety protocols; material accountancy procedures; contingency plans for unexpected conditions.
Equipment Deployment	Day 24	All recovery equipment (robotic systems, NDA instruments, temporary shielding, lifting equipment) shall be on-site and operational. Equipment may be sourced from IAEA, Iranian, or third-party suppliers as agreed in the Recovery Plan.
Recovery Commencement	Day 28 (14 days post-Report)	Physical recovery operations shall commence. If commencement is delayed due to safety preparations, both Parties shall notify the JIG in writing with revised timeline and justification.
Progress Reporting	Every 72 hours	IAEA shall submit written progress reports to the JIG every 72 hours during active recovery operations. Reports shall include: cylinders recovered; condition findings; any safety incidents; MUF calculations; estimated completion date.
Recovery Completion	As specified in Plan	All identified Category II and III cylinders shall be recovered, characterized, and either transferred to IAEA custody or placed under in-situ containment per Article 3.3. Final report issued within 7 days of completion.

Equipment access: Iran shall permit entry of all recovery equipment and technical personnel necessary for the Recovery Plan, including third-country robotics specialists, within 48 hours of Plan approval. Equipment shall be subject to IAEA seal verification only; no Iranian customs inspection that would compromise IAEA equipment integrity shall be required.

3.3 Unrecoverable Material — In-Situ Containment

If recovery is determined impossible (e.g., collapsed tunnel with no safe access route, cylinder fused to structural debris, radiation levels precluding any approach even by robotics), the affected material shall be subject to in-situ containment, not extraction:

1. **Permanent monitoring installation:** Iran and the IAEA shall install permanent monitoring equipment at the containment site, including:
    - Seismic sensors to detect tunneling, drilling, or structural disturbance
    - Radiation detectors to monitor for leakage or unauthorized material movement
    - Continuous camera surveillance with infrared capability for low-light conditions
    - Tamper-evident seals on all accessible access points
    - Environmental sampling ports for periodic swipe and air sample collection
2. **"Contained in place" designation:** The material shall be formally designated as "Contained in Place" in the IAEA inventory system. Such material shall not count against Iran's drawdown obligations under the parent framework unless and until it becomes recoverable through technological advancement or infrastructure repair.
3. **No delay provision:** Neither Party may use the unrecoverable status of contained material as a reason to delay compliance with other provisions of this Annex or any parent framework. Custody transfer and downblending of all accessible cylinders shall proceed on the established timeline regardless of any in-situ containment designations.
4. **Annual review:** The status of all Contained in Place material shall be reviewed annually by the IAEA. If technological advances or changed conditions permit safe recovery, the material shall be reclassified and recovery operations shall commence within 60 days of IAEA recommendation.

Article 4: No Delay of Custody Transfer or Downblending

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

4.1 Accessible Cylinders — No Delay. Neither Party may use damaged conditions, access disputes, or recovery complexity as a reason to delay: (a) IAEA custody transfer of accessible HEU cylinders; (b) downblending of accessible HEU cylinders under Pathway A of the parent framework; or (c) implementation of any other disposition pathway agreed by the Parties.

For all Category I (Intact) and Category II-A (Minor Damage) cylinders that can be safely moved:

- Custody transfer and downblending shall proceed on the timeline established in the parent framework regardless of ongoing recovery operations for damaged or inaccessible cylinders.
- The 14-day HEU consolidation timeline (parent framework Article 1.1) applies to all accessible cylinders without extension for facility damage elsewhere.
- The Day 45 Disposition Default circuit breaker (parent framework Article 1.6) shall be calculated based only on accessible material.

4.2 Inaccessible Cylinders — Parallel Processing

For Category III (Inaccessible) cylinders:

- The Parties shall prioritize in-situ monitoring and containment as described in Article 3.3.
- Any decision to delay custody transfer or downblending for inaccessible material requires unanimous JIG approval and shall not affect compliance assessments for accessible material.
- Contained in Place material is excluded from the Day 45 Disposition Default calculation unless the JIG determines by majority vote that recovery was feasible and Iran unreasonably declined to recover.

Table O-6: Material Category and Compliance Timeline Treatment

Category	Condition	Custody Timeline	Downblending Timeline	Circuit Breaker (Day 45)
I — Intact	Undamaged, accessible	Standard 14-day consolidation	Per parent framework	Included
II-A — Minor Damage	Damaged but movable with standard handling	Standard 14-day consolidation	Per parent framework	Included
II-B — Requires Debris Removal or Repair	Damaged, visible, but cannot be safely moved without prior work	Up to 30 days with IAEA-approved recovery plan	After recovery completion	Excluded unless JIG finds bad faith
III — Inaccessible	Cannot be safely accessed (structural collapse, radiation)	Deferred; in-situ containment within 30 days	Excluded	Excluded unless JIG finds recovery feasible & Iran unreasonably declined
IV — Missing	Declared in inventory but cannot be located	Immediate JIG investigation priority	Tier 3 investigation; possible diversion	Tier 3 investigation; possible diversion

Article 5: IAEA Verification of Damaged Areas

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

The IAEA shall have the right to deploy remote sensing and robotics to verify the status of damaged or inaccessible areas without requiring physical entry by inspectors. Iran shall provide all necessary permits, facility data, and operational cooperation for such deployments.

5.1 Permitted Remote Technologies

The IAEA may deploy the following remote verification technologies at declared facilities without restriction:

Table O-7: Approved Remote Verification Technologies

Technology	Capabilities	Application	Limitations
Aerial drones (UAVs)	Radiation detection (gamma and neutron); HD video and thermal imaging; GPS mapping	Overflight of damaged buildings; survey of areas with compromised roof structures	Weather dependent; limited flight time; not for indoor use without ventilation assessment
Remote-controlled ground vehicles (UGVs)	Manipulator arms for sample collection; radiation detectors; cameras with pan-tilt-zoom; two-way audio	Indoor survey of structurally compromised buildings; cylinder identification in debris	Requires relatively flat surfaces; debris may obstruct movement; tethered or radio-controlled
Seismic and acoustic sensors	Ground vibration detection; acoustic anomaly recognition; tamper-alert transmission	Detect unauthorized tunneling, drilling, or physical disturbance near contained material	Requires baseline calibration; may generate false positives from normal facility operations
Fiber-optic borehole cameras	High-resolution video through small-diameter openings; radiation-hardened models available	Visual inspection through existing openings, ventilation ducts, or newly drilled boreholes	Limited field of view; requires existing or newly created access path; depth limited by cable length
Robotic sampling systems	Remote swipe and air sample collection; sealed sample containment for laboratory analysis	Environmental sampling in areas unsafe for human entry; contamination mapping	Sample quality may vary compared to human-collected samples; cross-contamination risk if not properly sealed

5.2 Iranian Obligations for Remote Deployment

Iran shall facilitate all remote sensing deployments through the following concrete measures:

1. **Permit provision:** All necessary permits for drone overflight, ground vehicle operation, sensor emplacement, and borehole drilling within declared facility perimeters shall be provided within twenty-four (24) hours of IAEA request. No permit application may be denied except on verified aviation safety or nuclear safety grounds, and any denial shall be immediately appealable to the JIG.
2. **Facility data:** Iran shall provide to the IAEA, within forty-eight (48) hours of request: facility as-built drawings; pre-strike structural assessments; utility routing diagrams (electrical, ventilation, process piping); and any damage assessments prepared by Iranian authorities.

3. **Non-interference:** Iran shall not interfere with, jam, spoof, or disable remote sensing signals, drone command-and-control links, or data transmission systems. Any technical interference, whether intentional or attributable to negligence, constitutes a Tier 2 material breach.
4. **Safety coordination:** Iranian facility safety officers shall brief IAEA remote operators on known hazards (unstable structures, buried utilities, radiation hotspots) before each deployment.
5. **Site preparation:** Iran shall clear debris, provide access routes, and install temporary support structures as necessary to enable remote system deployment, within timeframes agreed in the Recovery Plan.

5.3 Data Ownership and Transmission

All remote sensing data collected under this Article shall be:

- Transmitted in real time, where technically feasible, to IAEA headquarters in Vienna via encrypted data link.
- Iran shall receive an identical encrypted copy of all data within seventy-two (72) hours of collection.
- Original IAEA-held data shall be stored as the archival record and shall constitute presumptive evidence in any dispute under this Annex. Iran may submit its copy for independent verification or cross-reference in dispute proceedings. Presumptive evidence status may be rebutted by showing, through technical documentation or chain-of-custody evidence, that the IAEA-held data was corrupted or improperly handled. The PCA Panel shall determine evidentiary weight in each dispute.
- Neither Party may unilaterally delete, modify, or withhold data. Any data integrity concerns shall be referred to the JIG for technical review within 48 hours.
- Neither Party may designate remote sensing data as confidential, secret, or restricted except with unanimous JIG approval on verified national security grounds unrelated to nuclear verification. Data classification requests shall not delay data transmission to either Party.

National Technical Means Saving Clause. Nothing in this Article shall be construed to limit, restrict, or otherwise affect the right of any guarantor state to collect, analyze, and act upon data derived from its national technical means of verification, including satellite imagery, signals intelligence, and other sources. Such data may be shared with the IAEA or JIG at the discretion of the collecting state. The Parties acknowledge that national technical means serve as a complementary verification tool and are not subject to the data ownership or transmission provisions of this Annex.

Article 6: Access Dispute Resolution

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

Any dispute arising from access denial, damage assessment disagreement, or recovery operation deadlock shall be resolved through binding arbitration under the Permanent Court of Arbitration (PCA) in The Hague, following a mandatory consultation period as specified below. The ruling shall be issued within seven (7) days of the filing of the dispute. No unilateral action shall be taken pending arbitration.

6.1 PCA Arbitration Framework

6.1-A. Pre-Arbitration Consultation Period. Before filing an access dispute, the requesting Party shall notify the JIG. A seven (7) day consultation period follows, during which the JIG shall facilitate a technical solution through joint expert assessment. Only after this period may arbitration commence, unless the IAEA certifies imminent proliferation risk, in which case expedited arbitration may begin within 48 hours.

6.1-B. Definition of "Imminent Proliferation Risk." For purposes of this Article, "imminent proliferation risk" means credible evidence that HEU cylinders within a denied-access area are at immediate risk of diversion, unauthorized removal, or deliberate dispersal. This includes, but is not limited to: (a) credible intelligence, including from national technical means, that HEU cylinders are or are about to be moved from a denied area; (b) denial of access to an area where the IAEA has a reasonable basis to believe diversion could occur undetected; (c) a pattern of behavior by Iran indicating an intent to frustrate verification of a specific storage location; or (d) any verified change in the physical condition of a containment area that suggests unauthorized access or removal of material. The IAEA shall provide a written factual basis for any such certification to the JIG within twelve (12) hours. The JIG may review the certification and, by two-thirds majority vote, return the matter to the consultation track if it finds the certification lacks any credible evidentiary basis. Such review does not suspend the expedited arbitration timeline unless the JIG so orders.

Table O-8: PCA Arbitration Parameters for Annex O Disputes

Parameter	Specification
Applicable Rules	PCA Optional Rules for Arbitration Involving International Organizations and States (2012), modified as specified herein
Panel Composition	Three members: (a) one appointed by Iran within 48 hours of dispute filing; (b) one appointed by the IAEA Director General within 48 hours; (c) one neutral chair appointed by the PCA Secretary-General within 72 hours if the Party-appointed members cannot agree on a chair.
Seat	The Hague, Netherlands
Language	English, with Persian and Arabic interpretation available upon request
Timeline	Pre-arbitration: 7-day JIG consultation period (unless IAEA certifies imminent proliferation risk). Ruling shall be issued within 7 days of the formal filing of the dispute. Expedited written proceedings unless the Panel determines oral hearings essential, in which case hearings shall be held within 4 days via secure video conference.
Provisional Measures	Either Party may request provisional measures (including mandatory access orders) within 24 hours of filing. The Panel shall rule on provisional measures within 48 hours.
Binding Effect	The award is final and binding on both Parties. Iran shall implement access rulings within 24 hours of issuance. Failure to comply triggers the consequences specified in Section 6.2.

Disputes subject to arbitration include but are not limited to:

- Denial of IAEA access to any area within a declared facility perimeter
- Disagreement over cylinder condition classification (Category I–IV)
- Iranian refusal to approve recovery operations recommended by the IAEA
- Disputes over whether a storage area is safe for human entry
- Disagreement over whether material should be classified as recoverable or subject to in-situ containment
- Any other matter that prevents the IAEA from completing its verification mandate under this Annex

6.2 Consequences of Access Denial

If either Party denies access or cooperation in violation of this Annex, the following consequences apply:

1. **Tier escalation (measured).** Each 24-hour period of access denial, after the 7-day JIG consultation period has expired without resolution, constitutes one (1) Tier 2 material breach under the parent

framework Article 13. Denial continuing for more than 72 hours after consultation failure escalates to Tier 3. Denial during the consultation period itself does not constitute a breach provided both Parties are engaging in good faith.

2. **Reporting obligation.** The IAEA shall report the denial to the JIG within twenty-four (24) hours of the denial, with full documentation of the access requested, the response received, and the proliferation risk assessment of the denied area. The JIG shall notify the UN Security Council only if the dispute remains unresolved after the 7-day consultation period.
3. **Burden of justification.** The denying Party bears the burden of demonstrating that access denial is based on credible safety concerns, structural instability, or other verified conditions. If the JIG or PCA Panel independently verifies such conditions, the denial shall not constitute a breach. If the JIG or Panel finds the justification insufficient, the consultation period shall be deemed to have concluded unsuccessfully and the breach timeline begins.
4. **Expedited arbitration.** Access disputes receive priority scheduling at the PCA. The Secretary-General shall convene the Panel within 48 hours of formal filing, regardless of ordinary caseload.
5. **Guarantor state notification.** All guarantor states under the parent framework Article 12 shall be notified within 24 hours of formal arbitration filing and may exercise their Mandatory Escalation Pause authority.

Article 7: Incorporation by Reference

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

This Annex may be incorporated into any existing or future agreement between the Parties by the following adoption sentence:

> *"The Parties adopt Annex O (IAEA Access and Site Integrity Protocol) as an operative provision of this Agreement. In the event of any inconsistency, Annex O governs with respect to IAEA access, damage assessment, and recovery operations for damaged nuclear material."*

No further amendment of the parent framework is required. This Annex enters into force upon the later of: (a) signature by both Parties; or (b) the effective date of the parent framework into which it is incorporated.

Article 8: Provisional Application

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

The Parties may agree to apply this Annex provisionally for a period of ninety (90) days, pending formal ratification or incorporation into a parent framework.

Provisional application shall be effected by an exchange of diplomatic notes between the Parties, copied to the Joint Secretariat and all guarantor states.

During provisional application, all provisions of this Annex shall be operative and binding. The IAEA shall exercise full access rights; Iran shall provide full cooperation; and all dispute resolution mechanisms shall be available.

Either Party may terminate provisional application with fourteen (14) days' written notice to the other Party, the Joint Secretariat, and the IAEA Director General.

Termination of provisional application by Iran triggers immediate JIG review and simultaneous notification to all guarantor states. The JIG shall convene within 48 hours to determine whether termination materially harms verification objectives. If the JIG finds by majority vote that such harm exists, the following apply:

a. The termination shall be reported immediately to the UN Security Council;
b. The termination shall constitute a Tier 2 material breach under parent framework Article 13, with each 24-hour period of continued non-application counting as a separate breach;
c. Guarantor states may, by majority vote, impose proportional consequences under parent framework Article 12, including but not limited to suspension of economic benefits, travel restrictions, or other measures;
d. Termination does not suspend or diminish any of Iran's obligations under the IAEA Statute or its existing Safeguards Agreement. All IAEA safeguards rights continue in full force.

Termination of provisional application does not relieve either Party of obligations under the IAEA Statute or existing Safeguards Agreement. All IAEA safeguards rights and Iran's safeguards obligations continue in full force regardless of the status of this Annex. Monitoring data collected during the provisional period remains subject to IAEA safeguards confidentiality protocols and may be used for safeguards purposes under the IAEA Statute.

Article 9: Severability

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

If any provision of this Annex is found by a court of competent jurisdiction or arbitral panel to be unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall remain in full force and effect.

The Parties shall promptly negotiate a replacement for any provision found unenforceable, preserving the original intent to the maximum extent possible. If the Parties cannot agree on a replacement within thirty (30) days, the matter shall be referred to the PCA for binding determination under the procedures specified in Article 6.

If the unenforceable provision is essential to the Annex's operation (as determined by the IAEA Director General or the JIG by majority vote), the Parties shall enter into good-faith negotiations to restructure the Annex. During such negotiations, all other Annex provisions continue in force.

Article 10: Duration and Withdrawal

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

This Annex shall remain in force indefinitely, unless: (a) both Parties agree in writing to terminate it; or (b) the parent framework into which it is incorporated terminates, and the Parties do not reaffirm this Annex within ninety (90) days of such termination.

Withdrawal from this Annex without withdrawal from the parent framework is not permitted. This Annex is integral to the verification and custody architecture and may not be severed unilaterally.

If the parent framework terminates and this Annex is not reaffirmed within ninety (90) days, all IAEA access rights under this Annex expire, but IAEA monitoring data collected during Annex O's operation remains the property of the IAEA and may be used for safeguards purposes under the IAEA Statute and applicable safeguards agreements.

Implementation Flexibility. The Parties recognize that damaged nuclear sites may present unforeseen conditions not contemplated in this Annex. Timelines and technical requirements in this Annex may be adjusted by mutual written agreement of the IAEA Director General and the Head of the Iranian Atomic Energy Organization (AEOI), with notification to the JIG. Unilateral extension or modification is not permitted. Any mutually agreed adjustment shall specify: the revised timeline or requirement; the technical justification; the conditions for return to the original timeline; and the notification provided to the JIG.

10.4-A. Guarantor Oversight of Mutual Adjustments. Any mutual agreement under Article 10.4 shall also be submitted to all guarantor states simultaneously with notification to the JIG. If three or more guarantor states object in writing within seven (7) calendar days of receipt, the adjustment shall be suspended pending JIG review. The JIG may reinstate the adjustment only by a two-thirds majority vote of all JIG members. The burden of demonstrating that the adjustment is technical, not political, and that it does not materially delay the parent framework's objectives rests on the Parties requesting the adjustment. This provision does not apply to day-to-day operational coordination, which requires only JIG notification.

This provision is not a general escape clause; it is a limited flexibility mechanism for genuinely unforeseen circumstances at damaged facilities. The burden of demonstrating that circumstances are unforeseen and material rests on the Party requesting the adjustment.

Signature Block

In witness whereof, the undersigned, being duly authorized by their respective governments, have signed this Annex O: IAEA Access and Site Integrity Protocol.

Done at ____________________, this _______ day of _____________________, 2026, in triplicate in the English language.

For the Islamic Republic of Iran:

Name: _________________________________

Title: _________________________________

Date: _________________________________

For the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA):

Name: Rafael Mariano Grossi, Director General

Date: _________________________________

For the United States of America (as endorsing Party, if parent framework applies):

Name: _________________________________

Title: _________________________________

Date: _________________________________

Witnessed by the Guarantor States:

Oman	Pakistan	Qatar
European Union (E3+)	People's Republic of China	Russian Federation